



MONTHLY UPDATE

Guinea-Bissau: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 • 5 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • DPI • DATA

Summary of the month

Three developments were recorded between 1 July and 19 August 2026. [The Instituto Nacional de Estatística released preliminary RGPH4 census results](#) on 23 July, putting the resident population at 2,191,202 – the country's first new population baseline since 2009 and its first fully digital census. The next day, [AUDA-NEPAD launched its Programme for African Developing Island Economies](#) at a ministerial segment in Abidjan, naming Guinea-Bissau among seven island states under a 2026–2031 roadmap that includes digital transformation as one of six pillars. In August [the government approved a national interoperability regulation](#), the first movement on a decree that had stood approved in draft since July 2025.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The digital integrity law was [passed unanimously with amendments by the transitional parliament on 21 May, framed by the government spokesman as targeting those who spread hate and act against the State](#), with enforcement mechanisms, including for citizens abroad, left unstated. Its publication and in-force dates are unconfirmed. It was [first invoked on 21 July by the communications ministry over a false claim that TikTok was being shut down in the country](#) – the first use the base records, and it is the state correcting a claim about itself.

Regional collaboration

[AUDA-NEPAD launched the Programme for African Developing Island Economies](#) at the Ministerial Segment of the Specialized Technical Committee on Trade, Industry and Minerals in Abidjan on 24 July 2026, covering Guinea-Bissau alongside Cabo Verde, the Comoros, Madagascar, Mauritius, Sao Tome and Principe and Seychelles. A 2026–2031 roadmap groups the seven states under six pillars, including connectivity and AfCFTA integration and digital transformation – with digital public infrastructure, artificial intelligence and automation named as accelerators. Ministers adopted a communique committing to the programme; no Guinea-Bissau-specific national action under it has yet been reported.

DPI

Data Exchange

[The government approved a national interoperability regulation](#), announced on 8 August 2026 by the World Bank-backed Western Africa Regional Digital Integration Program, which supports the work and presents the framework as Guinea-Bissau's contribution to the regional programme. A draft decree on the interoperability of public and

private digital systems had been approved by the Council of Ministers on 10 July 2025 and had not moved since; the announcement names no decree number, no gazettal and no entry-into-force date, and the paired data-governance and cybersecurity decrees approved alongside it in 2025 remain where they were.

Registries

The register moved without the electorate changing. The electoral support office [handed the updated register to the elections commission in physical and electronic form for the 30 August referendum, recording 966,152 registered voters — unchanged from the last update, having also issued 25,146 replacement voter cards in a 30-day nationwide operation from 13 July to 11 August through 51 brigades covering every region](#). So the month's work was replacing credentials rather than adding registrants, and no audit or de-duplication statement accompanies the handover.

Data

National statistics

[The Instituto Nacional de Estatística released RGPH4 preliminary results on 23 July 2026](#), putting resident population at 2,191,202 — cut from a raw collected base of 2,246,300 after correction for repeated names, against 1,449,230 in 2009. [50.7% are women and 45.7% urban; 304,939 households, 559,303 dwellings and 376,258 buildings were enumerated, using computer-assisted personal interviewing throughout](#). UNFPA and the World Bank financed the census; demographic, social, economic and housing tabulations are to be released progressively over the coming months.

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